the bass, slightly modified, is imitated at one bar's distance by a partial entry in the tenor, a second higher; then half a bar later the treble introduces a stretto maestrale, for all the voices, descending by thirds, and always at one crotchet's distance. The coda (bars 47 to 50) is similarly constructed to the episodes.

*Altogether a marvellous little fugue.

## FUGUE 30 (Book II, 6)

### D MINOR (THREE VOICES).

**Exposition.**—The subject—



is in the alto; as it reaches the dominant by step progressions and does not modulate, the answer, in the treble, is **real**. A countersubject, mostly in even semiquavers, accompanies it with the exception of its first half bar. The codetta (bar 5) is made from the inversion of the first half bar of the subject, treated imitatively. In bars 6 to 8 the bass takes the subject, the treble the countersubject.

There are few changes of key in this fugue, and it would be possible to regard the first stretti (bars 10 to 12, 14 to 16) as belonging to the opening section, and the middle section as characterised by inverse movement (from bar 17). But the position of the first episode, and the dissimilarity of these stretti to redundant entries or counter-exposition, render it unnatural to include them here. In any case, the division into three sections is not very clear.

*I cannot refrain from quoting the rest of the Author's characteristic comment in his MS., though it was not intended for publication:—"*Wonderful old fellow, Bach!*" [ED.]

Ebenezer Prout: Analysis of J. S. Bach's Forty-Eight Fugues
Ed. Louis B. Prout. London: Edwin Ashdown, 1910. Printed pp. 60-61.
BWV 875. Complete original pages; adjoining commentary is retained.
Full source scan

**Middle Section.**—The first episode (bars 8, 9) is formed from the fragment of incidental counterpoint in the alto of bar 7. In bars 10 to 12 the impression of a stretto in the octave, at three crotchets' distance, is produced, but the bass really breaks away from the subject before the treble enters. After a second episode (bars 12, 13), consisting of a different treatment of the material of the first, a closer stretto is given to the two upper voices, the answer succeeding the subject at the distance of one crotchet; the bass supplies the countersubject (bars 15, 16). In bar 17 answer and subject are given by inverse movement, again at one crotchet's distance; and in bar 18 the subject in G minor, in its direct form, by bass and alto at the same distance of time. A third episode (bars 19 to 24) separates these from the final entries; the first part of this episode is derived from the codetta, the rest from the matter of the previous episodes.

**Final Section.**—The final section consists of only three bars and contains a stretto in the octave at half a bar's distance, for the two upper voices, with the countersubject in the bass from bar 26.

After the exposition, nearly all the entries of the subject and countersubject are more or less incomplete.

---

## FUGUE 31 (Book II, 7)

### E FLAT MAJOR (FOUR VOICES).

A noteworthy feature of this fugue is the very small amount of modulation which it contains. Excepting at bar 53, where the key is A flat, the subject and answer are never introduced in any other keys than the tonic or dominant. It is, however, not